WHITE PAPER

PeopleSoft to Cloud ERP

A Migration Framework for Mid-Size Enterprises

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Topic	Industry	Audience
ERP Migration & Cloud Strategy	Enterprise Technology / Consulting	IT Leaders, CFOs, Operations Directors

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Executive Summary

Many mid-size enterprises continue to rely on legacy PeopleSoft ERP systems implemented a decade or more ago. While these systems remain functional, they increasingly struggle to meet modern business demands: real-time analytics, remote accessibility, scalability, and AI integration.

This white paper provides a structured, practical framework for migrating from on-premises PeopleSoft to modern cloud ERP. It is designed specifically for mid-size enterprises with limited IT budgets, lean transformation teams, and complex stakeholder environments.

Drawing on four years of hands-on PeopleSoft consulting experience at NTT DATA North America, this framework addresses the full migration lifecycle from readiness assessment through to post-migration optimization.

Key Findings

Global cloud ERP market projected to reach USD 40.5 billion by 2025, growing at 13.6% CAGR (Gartner, 2024).

Mid-size enterprises migrating to cloud ERP report an average 25 to 30% reduction in IT infrastructure costs within 2 years.

70% of ERP migration failures are attributable to change management and people factors, not technical issues (McKinsey, 2023).

Companies on on-premises PeopleSoft face average annual maintenance costs of USD 500K to USD 2M.

Cloud ERP implementations deliver full ROI within 2.5 to 3 years on average for mid-size enterprises.

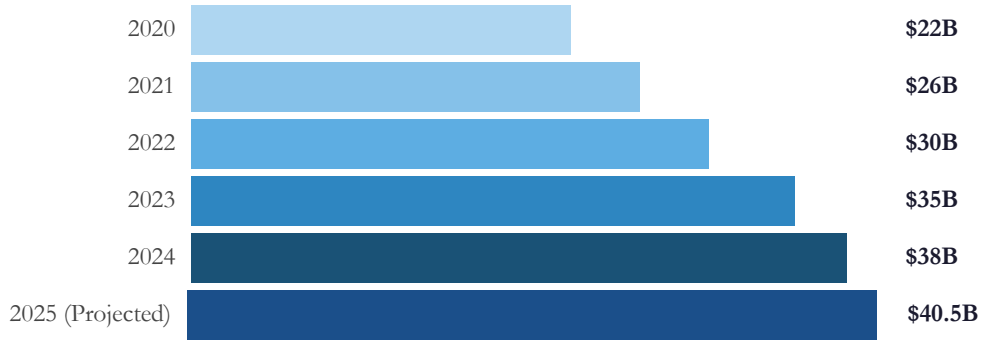
1. The Case for Migration

1.1 Why PeopleSoft Enterprises Are at a Crossroads

Pressure Factor	Detail
Vendor Direction	Oracle has shifted primary R&D to Oracle Cloud Fusion. PeopleSoft receives security patches but minimal new functionality.
Infrastructure Costs	On-premises PeopleSoft requires dedicated servers, DBA resources, and ongoing patches. Annual costs: USD 500K to USD 2M for mid-size firms.
Integration Complexity	Modern enterprises need seamless integration with CRM, BI, and AI tools. PeopleSoft integrations are largely custom-built and brittle.
Talent Scarcity	The pool of certified PeopleSoft consultants is shrinking. Cloud ERP skills are widely available.
Remote Accessibility	PeopleSoft was built for on-premises access. Post-pandemic hybrid work demands cloud-native, device-agnostic systems.
Reporting Limitations	PeopleSoft reporting requires SQL or PS Query knowledge. Cloud ERPs offer self-service dashboards out of the box.

1.2 Market Growth

Cloud ERP Market Size (USD Billions)



Source: Gartner Cloud ERP Market Guide, 2024

1.3 Expected Benefits Post-Migration

Benefits Reported After Cloud ERP Migration (% of companies)

Source: Panorama Consulting ERP Report, 2023

2. Pre-Migration Assessment

2.1 Organizational Readiness Framework

Dimension	What to Assess
Process Documentation	Are current PeopleSoft business processes fully documented? Undocumented processes are a major migration risk.
Data Quality	What is the current state of master and transactional data? Duplicates, missing fields, and format issues must be resolved before migration.
Stakeholder Alignment	Do Finance, HR, Supply Chain, and IT leaders all support the migration? Misalignment at leadership level is the top cause of stalled projects.
IT Capability	Does the internal team have cloud skills? Identify gaps early and plan for upskilling or external support.
Budget Clarity	Is the full migration budget approved, including a 20% contingency buffer?
Change Management Plan	Who will own user adoption? Research shows technology is only 30% of ERP success.

2.2 Common PeopleSoft Pain Points

- Heavily customized configurations that deviate from vanilla functionality, making cloud mapping complex
- Undocumented workarounds built around system limitations over years of operation
- Data inconsistencies between HR, Finance, and Supply Chain modules
- Shadow systems such as Excel trackers and Access databases filling PeopleSoft functionality gaps
- No data governance framework, resulting in duplicated or conflicting records
- Institutional knowledge existing only in the minds of long-tenured staff with no documentation

2.3 Oracle's Two Official Migration Paths to OCI

Oracle officially supports two distinct migration paths for PeopleSoft to Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI). The correct path depends on the organization's current PeopleSoft version and must be determined in Phase 1 before any other planning begins.

Migration Path Decision: How to Choose

STEP 1: Identify your current PeopleSoft application release and PeopleTools release.
STEP 2: On PeopleSoft 9.2 AND PeopleTools 8.58 or later? Use Path A: PeopleSoft Cloud Manager.
STEP 3: On PeopleSoft 9.1 or earlier? Use Path B: Manual Migration to OCI.

Source: Oracle Cloud Migration Guide for PeopleSoft (oracle.com/cloud/migration/peoplesoft)

	Path A: PeopleSoft Cloud Manager	Path B: Manual Migration
Eligibility	PeopleSoft 9.2 and PeopleTools 8.58 or later	PeopleSoft 9.1 or earlier
What It Is	Application-aware tool built by Oracle to migrate, deploy, and manage PeopleSoft on OCI. Automates migration and post-migration configuration.	Manual deployment of PeopleSoft on OCI-supported operating systems. Requires hands-on technical execution without automated tooling.
Configuration Changes Required	Minimal. Migrates the existing environment with minimal configuration, integration, or business process changes.	Moderate to significant. Manual migration requires careful technical planning and may need reconfiguration of integrations and OS-level settings.
Business Process Impact	Very low. Organizations keep the PeopleSoft they know while gaining OCI infrastructure benefits.	Depends on scope. If upgrading PeopleSoft version alongside migration, business process changes may be required.
Zero Downtime Migration	Supported via Oracle Zero Downtime Migration (ZDM) tool.	Supported via Oracle Zero Downtime Migration (ZDM) tool.
Oracle Resources	PeopleSoft Cloud Manager Guide at docs.oracle.com/cd/E52319_01/infoportal/cloudmgr.html	Migrate PeopleSoft to OCI Playbook at docs.oracle.com/en/solutions/learn-migrate-peoplesoft-oci
Certified Oracle Partners	TCS, Accenture, Capgemini, DXC Technology, Kyndryl, Mythics, Astute Business Solutions, Iteprof	TCS, Accenture, Capgemini, DXC Technology, Kyndryl, Mythics, Astute Business Solutions, Iteprof
Recommendation	**PREFERRED PATH. Faster, lower risk, less disruptive for organizations on supported versions.**	**Required for organizations on 9.1 or earlier. Consider upgrading to 9.2 first to unlock Cloud Manager benefits.**

2.4 Deployment Strategy

Independently of which Oracle migration path is chosen, organizations must also select a deployment strategy for how users transition to the new environment.

Strategy	Timeline	Risk Profile	Best For
Big Bang	6 to 12 months	HIGH: Full cutover at once. Any failure affects entire organization.	Smaller firms with simple processes and strong IT capability.
Phased	12 to 24 months	MEDIUM: Migrate module by module. Issues contained to one area. RECOMMENDED.	Most mid-size enterprises. Best balance of risk and speed.
Parallel Run	18 to 30 months	LOW: Run both systems simultaneously. Most expensive but safest.	Highly regulated industries with zero tolerance for downtime.

3. The Migration Framework

3.1 Five-Phase Overview

Phase	Timeline	Key Activities	Primary Deliverable
Phase 1	Weeks 1 to 4	Stakeholder interviews, current state mapping, business case, executive sign-off	Migration Readiness Report
Phase 2	Weeks 5 to 10	Vendor evaluation, fit-gap analysis, data quality audit, integration mapping	Vendor Selection Report + Data Quality Assessment
Phase 3	Weeks 11 to 20	System configuration, data cleansing, integration build, UAT preparation	Configured Cloud ERP + Clean Data Set
Phase 4	Weeks 21 to 26	UAT execution, defect resolution, user training, cutover planning	UAT Sign-off + Trained User Base
Phase 5	Weeks 27 to 30	Go-live, hypercare support, performance monitoring, post-migration review	Live System + Post-Migration Report

3.2 Phase 1: Discovery and Business Case

Key Activities

1. Conduct structured stakeholder interviews across Finance, HR, Supply Chain, and IT
2. Document all active PeopleSoft modules, customizations, and integration points
3. Quantify current annual infrastructure, licensing, and maintenance costs
4. Develop 5-year ROI model comparing stay-the-course versus migration
5. Present business case to C-suite and obtain formal project charter sign-off

Practitioner Insight

Projects that skip or rush the discovery phase are 3 times more likely to experience scope changes and budget overruns mid-project.

A strong business case does three things: quantifies the cost of inaction, sets realistic expectations, and establishes the metrics by which success will be measured post go-live.

At NTT DATA, the most common failure point was not technical complexity but insufficient stakeholder alignment at the start of the project.

3.3 Phase 2: Vendor Selection and Fit-Gap Analysis

Evaluation Criterion	What to Assess
Functional Coverage	Does the platform cover your core modules: HR, Finance, Procurement, Supply Chain?

PeopleSoft Migration Tools	Does the vendor offer PeopleSoft-specific data templates or migration accelerators?
Total Cost of Ownership	Compare license, implementation, and subscription costs over a 5-year horizon.
Integration Ecosystem	How easily does the platform connect with your existing CRM, BI, and third-party tools?
Regional Support	Does the vendor have certified implementation partners in your operating region?
AI and Analytics	What native AI and self-service reporting capabilities are included in the base license?
Upgrade Path	How are new features delivered? What is the vendor roadmap for the next 3 to 5 years?

Fit-Gap Classifications

- FIT: Cloud ERP handles the process in standard configuration. No changes required.
- PARTIAL FIT: Cloud ERP handles the process with minor configuration or workflow adjustment.
- GAP: Cloud ERP does not support the process in standard configuration. Requires customization, workaround, or process redesign.

A gap rate above 30% of processes is a warning signal. Either the vendor is not the right fit, or the enterprise must redesign core processes before migration.

3.4 Phase 3: Build, Configure, and Data Migration

Data Migration Golden Rules

Five Rules That Prevent Migration Failures

Rule 1: Never migrate dirty data. Cleanse first, migrate second.
Rule 2: Test migration scripts with production-like data, not dummy data.
Rule 3: Validate every migrated record against source PeopleSoft data before go-live sign-off.
Rule 4: Keep PeopleSoft live as a read-only fallback until data validation is 100% complete.
Rule 5: Assign one named person as data migration owner. Shared ownership means no ownership.

3.5 Phase 4: UAT and Training

UAT Element	Standard
Test Scope	All in-scope business processes tested end-to-end, not just individual transactions
Test Data	Anonymized production data used wherever possible

Defect Classification	Critical (blocks go-live), Major (workaround available), Minor (cosmetic or low impact)
Pass Criteria	100% of Critical defects resolved. 95% of Major defects resolved before sign-off.
Regression Testing	All previously passing cases re-executed after each batch of defect fixes
Business Sign-off	Named business owner from each function must formally sign UAT completion

Training Strategy

- Role-based training: different content for end users, managers, approvers, and system administrators
- Deliver training within two weeks of go-live to maximize retention
- Create quick reference cards for the top 10 most common tasks in the new system
- Identify and certify super users in each department to provide first-line peer support post go-live
- Record all training sessions for future onboarding of new employees

3.6 Phase 5: Go-Live and Hypercare

Hypercare Protocol

Weeks 1 to 2: War room activated. All critical issues resolved within 4 hours.
Weeks 3 to 4: Daily issue triage. SLA extends to 8 hours for critical, 24 hours for major issues.
Weeks 5 to 6: Weekly issue reviews. Super users take on first-line support.
Weeks 7 to 8: Transition to BAU support. Formal hypercare closure review.
Throughout: PeopleSoft remains live as read-only reference. Do not decommission until 12 weeks post go-live.

4. Cost-Benefit Analysis

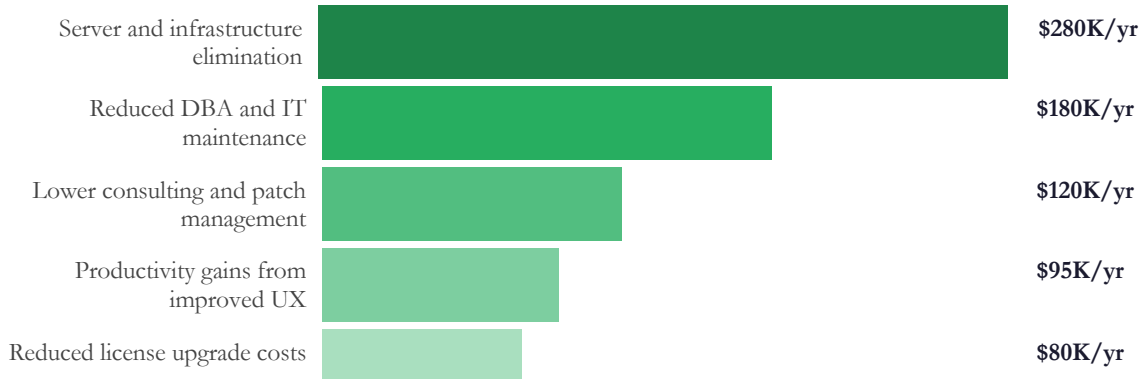
4.1 Typical Migration Cost Profile

The following estimates are based on industry benchmarks for mid-size enterprises with 500 to 2,000 users. Actual costs will vary based on scope, customization level, and vendor.

Cost Category	Low Estimate	High Estimate	Notes
Cloud ERP Licenses (Year 1)	$150,000	$400,000	Per user pricing. Varies by vendor and scope.
Implementation and Consulting	$300,000	$800,000	Largest cost driver. Depends on customization level.
Data Cleansing and Migration	$50,000	$150,000	Frequently underestimated. Budget generously.
Training and Change Management	$40,000	$100,000	Critical investment. Do not reduce this budget.
Infrastructure Transition	$20,000	$60,000	Decommissioning on-premises servers.
Contingency (20%)	$112,000	$302,000	Industry standard. Strongly recommended.
TOTAL MIGRATION COST	**$672,000**	**$1,812,000**	**One-time investment for full transformation.**

4.2 Annual Savings Post-Migration

Estimated Annual Savings Post-Migration (USD, Mid-Size Enterprise)



Total estimated annual savings: USD 755,000 per year post full migration.

4.3 ROI Timeline

Metric	Year 0	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4+
Migration Cost	($1.2M)	($200K)	($100K)	($80K)	($80K)
Annual Savings	$0	$300K	$600K	$755K	$755K
Cumulative Net	($1.2M)	($1.1M)	($600K)	$75K	$750K+
ROI Status	Investment	Investment	Break-even approaching	**POSITIVE ROI**	**Full ROI achieved**

Based on mid-range migration cost of USD 1.2M and average annual savings of USD 755K, full ROI is typically achieved in 2.5 to 3 years.

5. Real-World Case References

5.1 Lessons from Large-Scale ERP Migrations

The following cases are drawn from publicly documented migrations. While these organizations are larger than a typical mid-size enterprise, the principles and failure modes are directly transferable.

Case 1: Unilever | PeopleSoft to SAP Cloud

Organization: Unilever (global FMCG, 190,000 employees across 190 countries)
Migration: Fragmented legacy ERP including PeopleSoft HR to SAP S/4HANA Cloud

Key Lessons:
1. Standardized business processes BEFORE migration rather than replicating local variations. Reduced customizations by 60%.
2. Dedicated 40% of total project budget to training and user adoption activities.
3. Chose a phased, region-by-region rollout over 4 years instead of a big bang approach.

Outcome: 30% reduction in HR process costs. Real-time workforce analytics across all markets.
Source: SAP Case Study Library, 2022

Case 2: City of Los Angeles | PeopleSoft to Oracle Cloud

Organization: City of Los Angeles, USA (public sector, 50,000 employees)
Migration: PeopleSoft HR and Finance to Oracle Cloud HCM and ERP

Key Lessons:
1. Data quality audit found 23% of employee records had incomplete or inconsistent data. Cleansing this before migration prevented significant post go-live issues.
2. Over 200 department-level Excel shadow systems were formally identified and retired as part of the project.
3. 180 super users were trained across 44 city departments, creating an internal adoption network.

Outcome: USD 12M in annual operational savings. Employee self-service adoption of 87% within 6 months.
Source: Oracle Customer Success Story, 2023

Case 3: Mid-Size Manufacturing Firm | PeopleSoft 9.1 to Cloud ERP (Anonymized)

Organization: Mid-size manufacturing firm, 800 employees, 3 sites across 2 countries
Note: Details anonymized. Based on consulting engagement experience at NTT DATA.

Key Lessons:
1. Of 47 PeopleSoft customizations in active use, only 12 were business-critical post fit-gap analysis. Retiring the remaining 35 simplified the migration significantly.
2. The project experienced a 6-week delay in Phase 3 due to data quality issues not fully scoped in Phase 1, reinforcing the importance of adequate discovery investment.

3. Parallel running PeopleSoft for 8 weeks post go-live proved critical when three integration failures were found in week 2.

Outcome: 28% reduction in supply chain reporting time. Full ROI achieved in 2.7 years.

6. Risk Management

6.1 Migration Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Data loss or corruption during migration	**High**	**Critical**	Multiple data validation checkpoints. Maintain PeopleSoft as read-only backup for 12 weeks post go-live.
User resistance and low adoption	**High**	**High**	Invest in change management from Phase 1. Involve business users in design, not just testing.
Scope creep extending timeline and budget	**High**	**High**	Define scope boundaries in Phase 1. Use formal change request process for any additions.
Integration failures with connected systems	**Medium**	**High**	Map all integrations in Phase 1. Test in isolated environment before UAT begins.
Key person dependency	**Medium**	**Medium**	Document all decisions and configurations. Crosstrain team members throughout the project.
Budget overrun	**Medium**	**High**	Build 20% contingency into budget. Monthly budget tracking from Phase 1 onwards.
Vendor support limitations post go-live	**Low**	**Medium**	Negotiate SLAs in contract. Identify escalation paths before go-live date.

7. Success Metrics

7.1 KPI Framework

Define these metrics before go-live. Without pre-agreed success criteria, it is impossible to objectively evaluate whether the migration achieved its goals.

KPI	Target Benchmark
System Uptime	99.5% or above in first 90 days post go-live
Data Accuracy Rate	Less than 0.5% discrepancy rate in post-migration reconciliation
User Adoption Rate	80% of users logging in independently within 30 days of go-live
Support Ticket Volume	Declining week-on-week trend during 8-week hypercare period
Process Cycle Time	Measurable reduction in purchase order creation, payroll run, and financial close
Training Completion	100% of named users completing role-based training before go-live
Infrastructure Cost Reduction	Quantified reduction versus pre-migration baseline within 12 months
ROI Achievement	Positive cumulative ROI within 36 months of go-live

8. Tools and Technology Guide

Selecting the right tools across all layers of the migration stack is as important as the framework itself. This section provides a practical, vendor-neutral guide to the tools most used in PeopleSoft to cloud ERP migrations.

8.1 Cloud ERP Vendor Comparison

The four dominant cloud ERP vendors for mid-size enterprises are Oracle Cloud, SAP S/4HANA Cloud, Workday, and Microsoft Dynamics 365. Each has distinct strengths, pricing models, and PeopleSoft migration support levels.

Criterion	Oracle Cloud	SAP S/4HANA	Workday	Microsoft D365
PeopleSoft Migration Support	Excellent. Oracle offers dedicated PeopleSoft-to-Cloud tools and certified migration paths.	Good. SAP provides migration accelerators, but PeopleSoft mapping requires effort.	Limited. No PeopleSoft-specific tools. Requires full re-implementation approach.	Moderate. Microsoft partners offer PeopleSoft connectors but no native tooling.
Best For	Orgs already in Oracle ecosystem. Finance and HR-heavy migrations.	Large enterprises with complex supply chain and manufacturing processes.	HR and workforce management focused organizations.	Microsoft-centric organizations already using Azure, Teams, or Office 365.
Modules Covered	HR, Finance, Procurement, Supply Chain, Projects, Analytics	Finance, Supply Chain, Manufacturing, HR, Analytics	HR, Payroll, Finance, Planning	Finance, HR, Supply Chain, Sales, Customer Service
Pricing Model	Per user per month subscription. Module-based licensing.	Per user subscription. Significant implementation costs.	Per user per month. Transparent pricing model.	Per user per month. Flexible bundle options.
Implementation Time	9 to 18 months for mid-size	12 to 24 months for mid-size	6 to 12 months for HR-focused	9 to 18 months for mid-size
AI Capabilities	Strong. Native AI in Oracle Analytics, ERP forecasting, and HR insights.	Strong. SAP AI embedded across modules via Business AI suite.	Strong. Workday AI for workforce planning and finance insights.	Strong. Microsoft Copilot integration across all D365 modules.
Recommended For This Framework	BEST FIT for PeopleSoft migrations. Oracle ecosystem continuity reduces migration complexity.	Strong option if process redesign is planned alongside migration.	Consider only if HR is the primary migration scope.	Strong if Microsoft ecosystem is already in place.

Note: Oracle Cloud is the most natural migration path for PeopleSoft organizations due to Oracle's dedicated Cloud Migration Program (CMP) and PeopleSoft-to-Cloud data mapping templates.

8.2 Oracle's Official Migration Tools

Oracle provides two official, purpose-built tools for PeopleSoft to OCI migration. These should always be evaluated first before considering third-party alternatives.

PeopleSoft Cloud Manager (Path A Tool)

Available for: PeopleSoft 9.2 and PeopleTools 8.58 or later

PeopleSoft Cloud Manager is Oracle's application-aware migration and administration tool that automates the process of migrating, deploying, and managing PeopleSoft environments on OCI.

Key capabilities:
- Automates migration of PeopleSoft application and database to OCI infrastructure
- Manages ongoing PeopleSoft lifecycle: patching, upgrades, environment cloning
- Configures application services after migration is complete
- Supports Zero Downtime Migration (ZDM) to minimize business disruption
- Handles all OCI services the PeopleSoft application needs to run seamlessly

Official resource: docs.oracle.com/cd/E52319_01/infoportal/cloudmgr.html

Oracle Zero Downtime Migration (ZDM) Tool

Available for: Both Path A and Path B migrations

Oracle Zero Downtime Migration is a free Oracle tool that enables PeopleSoft environments to be migrated to OCI with minimal or zero downtime, keeping the business operational throughout the migration process.

Key capabilities:
- Automated, scripted migration with built-in validation checkpoints
- Supports both online (zero downtime) and offline migration modes
- Compatible with PeopleSoft Cloud Manager for Path A migrations
- Available for manual migrations on Path B as well
- Reduces the risk of data loss or service interruption during cutover

Recommended for any PeopleSoft migration where business continuity is critical.

8.3 Additional Migration Tools and Accelerators

Beyond Oracle's native tools, the following third-party tools are widely used in PeopleSoft migrations to accelerate specific workstreams such as testing, data quality, and legacy assessment.

Tool	Vendor	Best For	Key Capabilities
Panaya CloudQuality	Panaya	Test automation and impact analysis	AI-powered tool that analyses PeopleSoft customizations, identifies migration impact, and auto-generates test cases for the cloud environment. Significantly reduces UAT preparation time.

UiPath Test Suite	UiPath	Automated UAT script migration	Automates migration of manual test scripts from PeopleSoft UAT to cloud ERP test cases. Can reduce testing effort by up to 60%.
Rizing HCM Accelerator	Rizing (SAP Partner)	PeopleSoft HR to SAP Cloud only	Pre-built data migration templates and HR process mapping for organizations choosing SAP as the cloud target.
Rimini Street Assessment Tools	Rimini Street	Legacy ERP assessment	Third-party tools for PeopleSoft customization documentation and migration readiness reporting. Useful in Phase 1 discovery.

8.4 Oracle Certified Implementation Partners

Oracle maintains an official network of certified implementation partners for PeopleSoft to OCI migrations. Engaging a certified partner reduces project risk and ensures access to Oracle-trained consultants with PeopleSoft-specific migration experience.

Partner	Global Presence	Key Strength for PeopleSoft Migrations
Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)	Global, strong APAC and India presence	One of the largest Oracle PeopleSoft practices globally. Extensive experience with large-scale PeopleSoft to OCI migrations across HR, Finance, and Supply Chain.
Accenture	Global, strong North America and Europe	Deep Oracle Cloud expertise. Strong change management and business transformation capabilities alongside technical migration delivery.
Capgemini	Global, strong Europe and APAC	Established Oracle practice with PeopleSoft-specific migration accelerators. Strong in Finance and HR module migrations.
DXC Technology	Global, strong enterprise accounts	Specialized in complex, multi-country PeopleSoft migrations. Strong in heavily regulated industries such as government and healthcare.
Kyndryl	Global, strong infrastructure focus	Specialized in infrastructure migration and managed services. Ideal partner when OCI infrastructure management is a primary concern post-migration.
Mythics	North America focused	Oracle-exclusive partner. Deep PeopleSoft and OCI expertise with a focused, specialized practice for mid-size enterprises.

Full partner directory: partner-finder.oracle.com (filter by PeopleSoft expertise)

8.5 Additional Third-Party Migration Tools

The following tools round out a complete migration toolkit across testing, integration, data migration, and project management.

8.6 Integration Middleware

ERP systems do not operate in isolation. Integration middleware connects the cloud ERP to CRM, BI tools, third-party platforms, and legacy systems that will remain in place post-migration.

Tool	Vendor	Deployment Model	Key Strengths
MuleSoft Anypoint Platform	Salesforce	Cloud and on premises	Industry-leading iPaaS platform. Pre-built connectors for Oracle, SAP, Workday, and Salesforce. Strong governance and API management. Best choice for complex integration landscapes.
Dell Boomi AtomSphere	Boomi	Cloud-native	Low-code integration platform with extensive pre-built connectors. Strong for mid-size enterprises due to lower complexity and cost compared to MuleSoft.
Oracle Integration Cloud (OIC)	Oracle	Cloud-native	Native integration platform for Oracle Cloud ERP. Best choice when migrating to Oracle Cloud. Pre-built adapters for PeopleSoft reduce integration build time significantly.
Microsoft Azure Integration Services	Microsoft	Cloud-native	Best choice for Microsoft D365 migrations. Includes Logic Apps, API Management, and Service Bus. Strong if Azure is already the cloud infrastructure provider.
Workato	Workato	Cloud-native	AI-powered integration and automation platform. Growing adoption among mid-size enterprises for its no-code approach and competitive pricing.

8.7 Data Migration Tools

Data migration is the highest-risk technical activity in any ERP project. The right tooling reduces manual effort, improves data quality visibility, and provides audit trails for post-migration validation.

Tool	Vendor	Primary Use	Key Strengths
Informatica Intelligent Data Management Cloud	Informatica	Enterprise data migration and quality	Market leader for large-scale data migration. Strong data profiling, cleansing, and lineage capabilities. Trusted by Fortune 500 companies for ERP migrations.
Talend Data Fabric	Talend (Qlik)	ETL and data quality	Open-source roots with strong community support. Cost-effective option for mid-size enterprises. Good PeopleSoft extraction connectors.

Oracle Data Integrator (ODI)	Oracle	Oracle-to-Oracle migrations	Native tool for Oracle Cloud migrations from PeopleSoft. Pre-built mappings for common PeopleSoft to Oracle Cloud data structures.
IBM DataStage	IBM	Complex enterprise ETL	Enterprise-grade ETL tool. Suited to organizations with complex data transformation requirements across multiple source systems.
Microsoft Azure Data Factory	Microsoft	Cloud data integration	Best for Microsoft D365 migrations or organizations in Azure cloud. Strong integration with Azure analytics and storage services.
Trillium Data Quality	Syncsort	Data cleansing and profiling	Specialized data quality tool for pre-migration cleansing. Strong address validation, duplicate detection, and standardization capabilities.

8.8 Project Management Tools

ERP migrations require disciplined project management across workstreams, stakeholders, and timelines. The following tools are widely used in enterprise ERP projects.

Tool	Vendor	Best For	Key Features for ERP Projects
Microsoft Project	Microsoft	Enterprise project scheduling	Industry standard for ERP project scheduling. Gantt charts, resource management, critical path analysis. Widely used by consulting firms including NTT DATA.
Jira	Atlassian	Agile workstream tracking	Strong for tracking UAT defects, sprint-based configuration tasks, and integration build progress. Widely adopted in technology-led ERP projects.
ServiceNow Strategic Portfolio Management	ServiceNow	Large programme governance	Enterprise-grade programme management. Ideal for multi-workstream ERP programmes with governance and executive reporting requirements.
Smartsheet	Smartsheet	Collaborative project tracking	Accessible alternative to MS Project. Strong for cross-functional teams that include non-technical business stakeholders. Easy to share and update.
Monday.com	Monday.com	Visual project management	Highly visual project board. Good for mid-size ERP projects where ease of adoption is prioritized over advanced scheduling features.
Confluence	Atlassian	Project documentation	Best-in-class tool for ERP project documentation: meeting notes, decision logs, process designs, and training materials. Works seamlessly with Jira.

Tool Selection Recommendation

For Oracle Cloud migrations: Oracle CMP + Oracle Integration Cloud + Oracle Data Integrator + Microsoft Project + Jira + Confluence

For SAP migrations: Rizing Accelerator + MuleSoft + Informatica + Microsoft Project + Jira + Confluence

For Microsoft D365 migrations: Azure Integration Services + Azure Data Factory + Microsoft Project + Jira

Regardless of vendor: Jira for defect tracking, Confluence for documentation, and a dedicated data quality tool are non-negotiable for enterprise ERP projects.

9. Conclusion

Migrating from PeopleSoft to a cloud ERP platform is one of the most significant technology decisions a mid-size enterprise will make. Done well, it delivers lasting competitive advantage through reduced costs, better data, and a technology foundation ready for AI-driven innovation.

This framework is grounded in the realities of enterprise ERP consulting, not theoretical best practices. The five-phase approach, the emphasis on data quality and change management, and the risk register all reflect direct experience with PeopleSoft environments at enterprise scale.

The most important insight: successful cloud ERP migration is 30% technology and 70% people and process. Organizations that invest in stakeholder alignment, data quality, and user adoption consistently outperform those that treat migration as a purely technical exercise.

About the Author

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Prior to her MBA, she spent 4 years at NTT DATA North America within the PeopleSoft Oracle practice, progressing from Graduate Trainee to Information Technology Analyst. In that role she supported enterprise PeopleSoft implementations across operations and supply chain processes, resolving 20 to 30 system issues per release cycle and collaborating across 10-member cross-functional teams to deliver on-time system deployments for global clients.

This white paper is an independent work produced by the author drawing on that professional experience. It does not represent the views of NTT DATA or any other organization. All frameworks, recommendations, and templates are the author's own.

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Glossary of ERP Terms

Term	Definition
BAU (Business as Usual)	Normal day-to-day business operations, as distinct from project or transformation activities.
Big Bang Migration	A migration approach where all users and processes switch to the new system simultaneously on a single go-live date.
Change Management	The structured process of managing the people side of change to achieve the desired business outcome from a new system.
Cloud ERP	Enterprise Resource Planning software hosted on remote servers, accessed via the internet, and managed by the vendor rather than the organization's internal IT team.
Cutover	The point at which users stop using the old system and begin using the new system. The most operationally risky moment in any migration.
Data Cleansing	The process of detecting and correcting inaccurate, incomplete, duplicate, or improperly formatted records before migration.
ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning)	Integrated software that manages core business processes including Finance, HR, Supply Chain, and Operations in a single system.
Fit-Gap Analysis	A structured comparison between an organization's required business processes and the standard functionality of a target cloud platform.
Go-Live	The date on which the new system becomes the operational system of record for the organization.
Hypercare	The intensive support period immediately following go-live, typically 4 to 8 weeks, with dedicated resources to resolve issues rapidly.
Legacy System	An older technology system still in use despite newer alternatives, often because replacing it is costly or complex.
Master Data	Core business data such as employee records, vendor lists, and customer accounts shared across multiple processes and systems.
Parallel Run	Running the old and new systems simultaneously after go-live to validate outputs and provide a fallback option.
PeopleSoft	An ERP suite originally developed by PeopleSoft Inc., acquired by Oracle in 2005. Widely used for HR, Finance, and Supply Chain.
Phased Migration	A migration approach where different modules or business units migrate sequentially in waves rather than all at once.
ROI (Return on Investment)	A financial metric measuring net benefit relative to cost. Expressed as a percentage or payback period in years.
SaaS (Software as a Service)	A software delivery model where applications are hosted in the cloud and accessed via subscription, not installed locally.

Shadow System	An unofficial system such as an Excel spreadsheet used alongside the official ERP to fill functionality gaps.
Super User	A business user who receives advanced system training and serves as a first point of contact for peer support post go-live.
UAT (User Acceptance Testing)	The final testing phase in which business users validate that the configured system meets requirements before go-live sign-off.

Appendix A: Organizational Readiness Assessment Template

Score each dimension from 1 (not ready) to 5 (fully ready). A total score below 18 indicates the organization needs significant preparation before beginning migration.

Dimension	Assessment Questions	Score (1-5)	Actions Required
Process Documentation	Are current-state processes documented? Are process owners identified?	__ / 5	
Data Quality	Has a data quality assessment been done? Are data owners assigned?	__ / 5	
Stakeholder Alignment	Do all executive sponsors formally support the migration?	__ / 5	
IT Capability	Does the IT team have cloud skills? Have gaps been resourced?	__ / 5	
Budget Clarity	Is the full migration budget approved including 20% contingency?	__ / 5	
Change Management	Is a change lead assigned? Is a communication plan in place?	__ / 5	
TOTAL SCORE	**18 to 30: Proceed. 12 to 17: Address gaps first. Below 12: Not ready.**	**__ / 30**	

Appendix B: Fit-Gap Analysis Template

Complete one row per business process during Phase 2. The output directly informs implementation scope, timeline, and budget.

Process Area	Process Name	Classification	Priority	Action Required
HR	Employee Onboarding	**FIT**	High	No action required. Standard cloud ERP workflow covers this.
HR	Performance Review	**PARTIAL FIT**	Medium	Minor config needed to match existing rating scale and workflow.
Finance	Purchase Order Approval	**GAP**	High	Custom approval matrix required. Estimated 3 days development.
Finance	Multi-Currency Payments	**FIT**	High	Standard functionality. No customization needed.
Supply Chain	Vendor Portal Integration	**GAP**	Medium	API integration with existing vendor portal required.
[Area]	[Process Name]	[FIT / PARTIAL / GAP]	[H/M/L]	[Describe required action]

Appendix C: UAT Sign-Off Template

This is a ready-to-use UAT sign-off template for practitioners running a PeopleSoft to cloud ERP migration project. Copy this into your project documentation system, complete all fields at the end of Phase 4, and obtain sign-off from named business leads before authorizing go-live.

How to Use This Template

Step 1: Copy this template into Confluence, SharePoint, or your project documentation tool.
Step 2: Complete Part 1 (UAT Summary) as UAT execution progresses through Phase 4.
Step 3: Complete Part 2 (Defect Summary) once all test cycles are finished.
Step 4: Complete Part 3 (Training and Readiness) at least 1 week before planned go-live.
Step 5: Circulate the completed template to all named business leads for review.
Step 6: Obtain sign-off from all stakeholders in Part 4 before go-live is authorized.
Step 7: Archive the signed document as a formal project governance record.

PART 1: UAT EXECUTION SUMMARY

Field	Details
Project Name	
Organization Name	
Target Cloud ERP Platform	Oracle Cloud / SAP S/4HANA / Workday / Microsoft D365 (circle one)
Oracle Migration Path Used	Path A: PeopleSoft Cloud Manager / Path B: Manual Migration (circle one)
PeopleSoft Version Being Migrated From	
UAT Start Date	
UAT End Date	
UAT Environment URL	
UAT Lead (Business)	Name: Department:
UAT Lead (Technical)	Name: Department:
Total Test Cases Planned	
Total Test Cases Executed	
Test Execution Rate	% (Target: 100% before sign-off)
UAT Rounds Completed	Round 1 / Round 2 / Round 3 (circle all completed)

PART 2: DEFECT SUMMARY

Defect Category	Total Found	Resolved	Outstanding	Go-Live Criteria	Met?
Critical (blocks go-live)				0 outstanding required	Yes / No
Major (workaround available)				95% resolved required	Yes / No
Minor (cosmetic / low impact)				No minimum required	Yes / No
TOTAL					

List all outstanding Critical and Major defects below with planned resolution date:

ID	Defect Description	Category	Business Impact	Owner	Resolution Date
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					

PART 3: TRAINING AND GO-LIVE READINESS

Readiness Checklist Item	Owner	Status	Notes
All end users have completed role-based training		Complete / Pending	
Super users trained and certified in each department		Complete / Pending	
Quick reference guides distributed to all users		Complete / Pending	
Helpdesk team briefed and ready for go-live support		Complete / Pending	
Cutover plan reviewed and approved by IT lead		Complete / Pending	
Data migration validation 100% complete		Complete / Pending	
All integrations tested and signed off by IT		Complete / Pending	
Hypercare support rota confirmed for go-live week		Complete / Pending	

PeopleSoft read-only access confirmed post go-live		Complete / Pending	
Executive leadership briefed on go-live date		Complete / Pending	
Communication sent to all users about go-live		Complete / Pending	
Rollback plan documented and approved		Complete / Pending	

PART 4: GO-LIVE RECOMMENDATION AND SIGN-OFF

Proposed Go-Live Date	
Overall UAT Result	PASS / FAIL (circle one)
Go-Live Recommendation	APPROVED TO PROCEED / NOT APPROVED (circle one)
Reasons if Not Approved	
Conditions Attached to Approval	e.g. Defect #3 must be resolved by [date]

By signing below, each business representative confirms they have reviewed the UAT results, are satisfied that the system meets requirements for their functional area and authorize the project to proceed to go-live on the proposed date.

Function / Role	Full Name	Signature	Date
Finance Lead			
HR Lead			
Supply Chain Lead			
IT Lead			
Project Manager			
Executive Sponsor / CIO			

Important Note for Practitioners

This UAT Sign-Off template is provided as part of an independent white paper by Payal Devendra Jarviya.
It is based on enterprise consulting best practices from real-world PeopleSoft implementations.
Adapt field names, ownership, and criteria to suit your organization before use.
This template does not constitute legal or contractual advice.
White Paper: PeopleSoft to Cloud ERP: A Migration Framework for Mid-Size Enterprises

Appendix D: Key Takeaways and Further Reading

This section summarizes the most important lessons from this white paper and points practitioners to authoritative resources for deeper research.

D.1 The 10 Most Important Lessons from This Framework

1	Determine your PeopleSoft version before anything else. It decides whether you use Cloud Manager (Path A) or Manual Migration (Path B). Everything else flows from this.
2	The business case must quantify the cost of inaction, not just the cost of migration. Staying on PeopleSoft has a price too.
3	Data quality is the highest-risk technical activity in any ERP migration. Cleanse first, migrate second. Never the other way around.
4	70% of ERP migration failures are caused by people and process issues, not technology. Invest in change management from day one.
5	A gap rate above 30% in your fit-gap analysis is a warning signal. Either the vendor is wrong or the processes need redesigning before migration.
6	Never decommission PeopleSoft immediately after go-live. Keep it live as a read-only reference for at least 12 weeks post go-live.
7	Super users are your most valuable investment. Train them well and they will carry the organization through the first 90 days.
8	Oracle Zero Downtime Migration (ZDM) is available for both migration paths and is free. There is no excuse for extended downtime during cutover.
9	Define your success KPIs before go-live, not after. Without pre-agreed metrics, success becomes a matter of opinion.
10	The phased migration strategy is the right choice for most mid-size enterprises. Big bang is high risk. Parallel run is expensive. Phased is the balance.

D.2 Official Oracle Resources

Resource	URL
PeopleSoft Migration to OCI Hub	oracle.com/cloud/migration/peoplesoft
PeopleSoft Cloud Manager Guide	docs.oracle.com/cd/E52319_01/infoportal/cloudmgr.html
Migrate PeopleSoft to OCI Playbook	docs.oracle.com/en/solutions/learn-migrate-peoplesoft-oci
Oracle Zero Downtime Migration	oracle.com/database/technologies/rac/zdm.html
PeopleSoft on OCI Workshop (Hands-on Lab)	livelabs.oracle.com (search: PeopleSoft OCI)

Oracle Partner Finder	partner-finder.oracle.com (filter: PeopleSoft expertise)
OCI vs AWS vs Azure Comparison	oracle.com/cloud/service-comparison
Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Foundations Cert	oracle.com/cloud/training (OCI Foundations)

D.3 Recommended Reading

Title	Source
ERP Report 2023: Clash of the Titans	Panorama Consulting Group (panorama-consulting.com)
Gartner Cloud ERP Market Guide	Gartner Research (gartner.com) - available via institutional access
The People Side of ERP Implementation	McKinsey & Company Digital Insights (mckinsey.com)
Oracle PeopleSoft Reference Architectures	docs.oracle.com/solutions (search: PeopleSoft)
State of Texas PeopleSoft to OCI Case Study	docs.oracle.com/cd/E52319_01/infoportal/state_of_texas_comptroller_of_public_accounts.html
Cloud ERP Implementation Success Factors	MIT Sloan Management Review
Change Management in ERP Projects	Prosci ADKAR Model (prosci.com)

About This White Paper

Title: PeopleSoft to Cloud ERP: A Migration Framework for Mid-Size Enterprises

Author: Payal Devendra Jarviya

Status: Independent research white paper. Not affiliated with or endorsed by NTT DATA or any other organization.

Basis: Produced independently drawing on 4 years of professional experience in enterprise PeopleSoft consulting at NTT DATA North America.

Data sources: All statistics are attributed to publicly available industry reports (Gartner, Panorama Consulting, McKinsey). Anonymized case references are based on general consulting experience and do not refer to any specific client.

This document is intended for educational and professional development purposes. Practitioners should adapt all frameworks and templates to their specific organizational context before use.

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